Stage 1: Section 8 Notice & Service Pack

Service Playbook

Form 3A notice is the current Form 3A Section 8 notice for England.

This pack aligns the notice, service, and evidence so your case doesn't fall apart on technical errors.

Most possession cases fail on notice, service, or consistency errors — this pack is designed to prevent those.

PROPERTY	16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX
TENANT	Ivy Carleton
NOTICE	Form 3A notice
NOTICE SERVICE DATE	30 April 2026
NOTICE EXPIRY DATE	28 May 2026
EARLIEST PROCEEDINGS DATE	28 May 2026

Service Playbook

STEP 1 — PREPARE

Prepare the notice pack before anything is served

Print or save the Form 3A notice, keep a clean copy, and make sure the notice date, expiry date, and earliest proceedings date all match the rest of the file.

- Keep one clean copy for service and one copy for your records.
- Check that the grounds, dates, and arrears schedule line up before the notice leaves your hands.
- Keep the compliance snapshot with the file so you know what still needs attention.

STEP 2 — SERVE

Serve the Form 3A notice in a way you can prove later

Use first class post and keep the proof of posting. This is usually the cleanest option when you need a straightforward service record.

- Serve the same notice that appears in this pack.
- Record the exact date of service and the method used.
- Do not alter the service record after the event unless you are correcting it transparently across the whole file.

STEP 3 — RECORD

Build the service evidence immediately

Keep proof of posting, delivery notes, photographs, or attendance notes straight away. Service evidence is often what saves or weakens the case later.

- Keep proof of posting or a written attendance note.
- Keep the served notice copy with the same dates shown on the N215 certificate.
- Store every service document in the same case file so nothing has to be rebuilt later.

STEP 4 — ALIGN

Keep the notice, N215, and later court file saying the same thing

Most possession cases fail on inconsistency, not because the landlord lacked a form. Keep the notice, service record, arrears evidence, and any later court paperwork aligned from the start.

- Check the notice date, expiry date, and earliest proceedings date against the whole file.
- Make sure the grounds and arrears position stay consistent if the case moves into court.
- If the tenant does not leave, move into Stage 2 so the court file builds directly from this served notice record.

FAILURE RISK

Incorrect service can delay or undermine the claim

If the tenant disputes service or the dates do not match across the notice, N215, and later court papers, the case can be delayed or weakened even where the underlying grounds are sound.

Action: Keep the service record complete and aligned before you move on.

File Notes

The claimant seeks possession of 16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX relying on Ground 8 (Rent arrears), Ground 10 (Any rent arrears).

Form 3A notice served on 30 April 2026, expiring on 28 May 2026, with proceedings not intended before 28 May 2026.